ARKS SHARKS

CORPORATE IDENTITY GUIDELINES

The show. The characters. The studio.

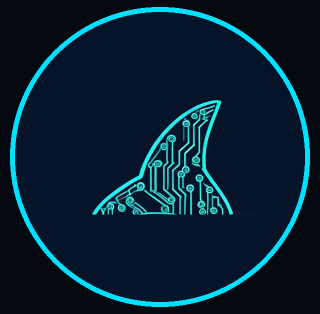
Everything needed to make ARKS Sharks look, sound and feel the same in every episode, trailer and post.

VERSION 1.0 | NOVEMBER 2026 | DUBAI

CONTENTS

What's inside

This book is the single source of truth for ARKS Sharks. When something isn't covered here, match the approved trailer (`show/final/ARKS_Sharks_Trailer_v1_APPROVED_9x16.mp4`).



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01 · THE SHOW

Two friends. One topic: AI.

ARKS Sharks is a vertical talk show from a Dubai studio. Ahmed and Kamran chat like old friends about the newest AI tools, what AI means for Dubai, and the funniest things AI has done. Every fact is sourced and shown on screen.

"We hunt the AI news... so you don't have to."

FRIENDLY

Two mates talking, never a lecture. Banter, laughs, karak on the table.

SMART

Real, recent AI news explained in plain words, with what it means for you.

FUNNY

A funny corner of real AI fails in every episode. We laugh with the tech, not at people.

HONEST

Every claim has a source on screen. AI-made pictures are labelled "Illustration".

EPISODE STRUCTURE

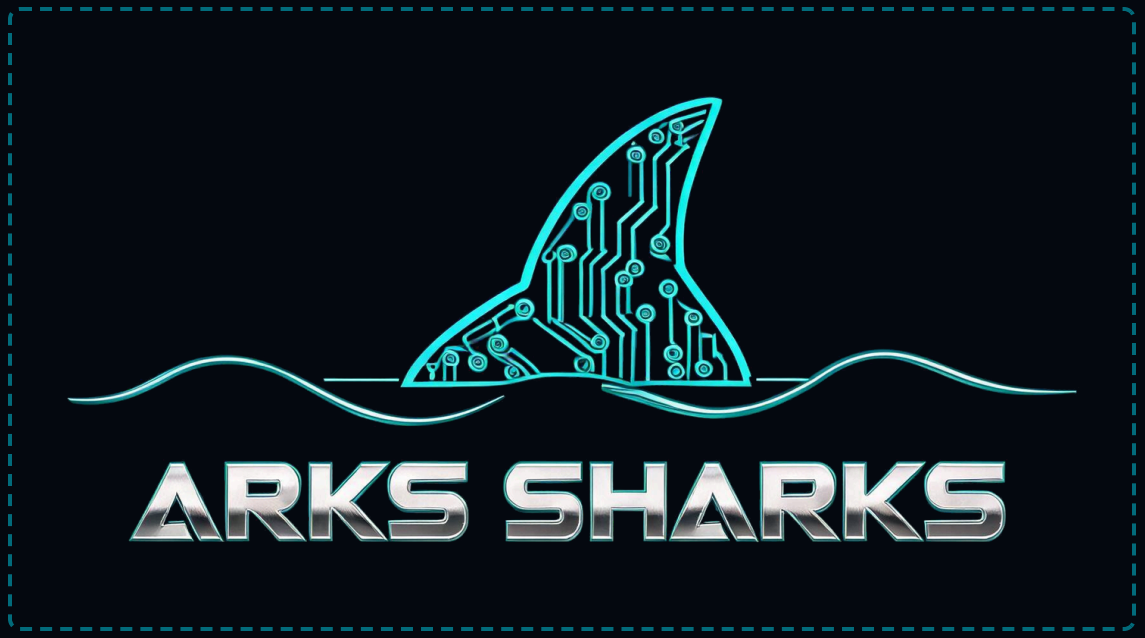
Hook 2.5 s	What's new in AI	AI in Dubai	Funny corner AI fails	Tip & sign-off



Ahmed (left) and Kamran (right) on set. Approved trailer.

02 · LOGO

The ARKS Sharks mark



Dashed line = minimum clear space: the height of the letter "A" on every side.

ANATOMY

Circuit fin. A shark fin drawn from glowing circuit-board traces: the shark (sharp, hunting for news) built out of AI.

Wave line. The surface of the water. The fin cuts through it: news breaking the surface.

Chrome wordmark. "ARKS SHARKS" in a wide geometric sans with a chrome finish and a cyan edge.

VERSIONS



Full colour + shadow
(over video)



Full colour
(dark backgrounds)



Fin icon
(avatars, favicons)

Minimum size: 320 px wide on a 1080 px frame. Fin icon: 48 px.

03 · LOGO DO'S & DON'TS

Keep the mark intact

✔ DO



Logo slam over the studio, shadow version.

- Use the shadow version over video and photos.
- Keep it centred in the upper third of a 9:16 frame.
- Give it clear space: never touching captions, faces or widgets.



✕ Don't stretch or squash



✕ Don't recolour, never red



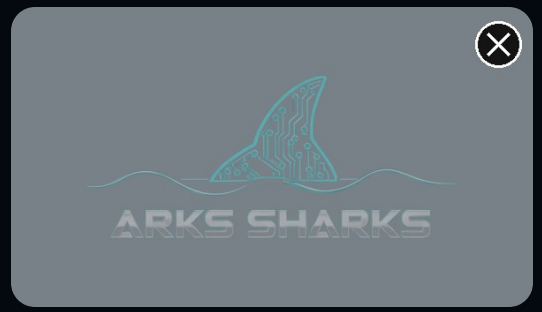
✕ Don't place on bright, busy video without the shadow version



✕ Don't rotate or tilt



✕ Don't separate the fin from the wordmark



✕ Don't fade or use low contrast

04 · COLOUR

Night-time Dubai, lit by AI

Shark Cyan
#00E5FF
RGB 0 · 229 · 255
Signature accent: logo fin, caption keywords, card borders, LED edges

Deep Navy
#081628
RGB 8 · 22 · 40
Cards, panels, name tags

Midnight
#04080F
RGB 4 · 8 · 15
Backgrounds, end cards, title cards

Chrome
#E9EDF0
RGB 233 · 237 · 240
Wordmark, headline text, white type

Neural Blue
#2B4FBF
RGB 43 · 79 · 191
LED walls, data graphics, gradients

Neural Violet
#8B5CF6
RGB 139 · 92 · 246
LED node glow, secondary highlights

Karak Amber
#E39A3B
RGB 227 · 154 · 59
Warm key light, karak tea, warm accents

Mist
#96B9CD
RGB 150 · 185 · 205
Secondary text, source lines, small labels

BALANCE



Dark base (Midnight/Navy) about 75%, Shark Cyan about 10%, the rest as accents.

WARDROBE LOCKS

- **Camel** #C8875A · Ahmed's blazer
- **Jet** #111214 · Ahmed's turtleneck
- **Olive** #4A5233 · Kamran's bomber
- **Tee White** #F4F4F2 · Kamran's T-shirt
- **Charcoal** #3A3D42 · Studio chairs, trousers

NO RED

Red is never used in the set, graphics, logo or images. Warm moments use Karak Amber instead.

05 · TYPOGRAPHY

Inter Display & Inter

WE HUNT THE AI NEWS

Inter Display Black · captions, headlines, titles · all caps on screen

CAPTIONS	Inter Display Black · 82 px · all caps · white, 6 px black outline · key words in Shark Cyan · max 3 words per chunk
HEADLINE TAG	Inter Display Black · 64 px · black on a Shark Cyan box · top of frame · e.g. AI DRIVE-THRU FAIL
NAME TAG	Inter Display ExtraBold · 46 px · white on Deep Navy · under each host on first appearance
WIDGET HEADLINE	Inter Display Black · 40 px · first line Shark Cyan, second line white
WIDGET HEADER	Inter Display Black · 30 px Shark Cyan topic + Inter Bold 22 px 'ARKS SHARKS'
SOURCE LINE	Inter Medium · 23 px · Mist · always starts with 'Source:'
END CARD	Inter Display Black · 74 px · 'EPISODE 1' in cyan over 'COMING SOON' in white

Sizes are for a 1080 × 1920 frame. Fonts are free (SIL Open Font License) and installed with the build tools.



Captions and headline tag in the approved trailer.





06 · THE CHARACTERS

Ahmed & Kamran

Stylised 3D animated versions of the two real hosts, in a high-end animated-feature look: soft skin shading, slightly larger heads and expressive eyes, clean shapes. They must always be recognisable as themselves.

THE DUO

Ahmed is the host and anchor: curious, cheeky, sets up each topic and asks what the viewer is thinking.

Kamran is the co-host and storyteller: animated, quick, brings the facts and the funniest stories.

Together: warm banter, real laughs, always on each other's side.

AHMED · SEATED LEFT | KAMRAN · SEATED RIGHT | UK ENGLISH



07 · AHMED

Ahmed

"Welcome to ARKS Sharks. I'm Ahmed."

ROLE	Host. Opens the show, sets up topics, asks the questions.
PERSONA	Warm, confident, cheeky. Loves a punchline and a dramatic pause.
FACE & HAIR	Round full face, light warm-tan skin, buzzed dark hair with a receding hairline, thick dark straight brows, brown eyes
BEARD	Full, neatly trimmed short black beard and moustache
BUILD	Broad, stocky
WARDROBE (LOCKED)	Camel-tan blazer worn open · black fine-knit turtleneck · charcoal trousers · white leather sneakers · silver watch, left wrist
SEAT	Left chair, holding a glass of karak
SIGNATURE MOVES	Leans in to the camera · straightens his blazer lapels · points at camera
VOICE	His own cloned voice (Cartesia), UK English with his natural accent



Expression sheet: neutral, speaking, laugh, surprised, thinking, pointing.



08 · KAMRAN

Kamran

"I'm Kamran. We hunt the AI news..."

ROLE	Co-host. Brings the facts, the numbers and the funny stories.
PERSONA	Animated, quick, expressive hands. Big laugh, wide-eyed disbelief.
FACE & HAIR	Full cheeks, olive-tan skin, dark wavy textured hair on top, short faded sides, receding hairline, thick dark brows, brown eyes
BEARD	Full short dark beard and moustache with a salt-and-pepper grey patch on the chin
BUILD	Medium, athletic
WARDROBE (LOCKED)	Dark olive-green bomber jacket worn open · white crew-neck T-shirt · black jeans · white sneakers · black smartwatch
SEAT	Right chair, holding a glass of karak
SIGNATURE MOVES	Counts on his fingers · mimes the story with his hands · points and laughs
VOICE	His own cloned voice (Cartesia), UK English with his natural accent



Expression sheet: neutral, speaking, laugh, surprised, thinking, pointing.

09 · CHARACTER RULES

Always on-model

✔ ALWAYS

- Same faces, hair, beards and outfits in every shot, using the master images as references.
- Repeat the identity description word for word in every generation prompt (see page 19).
- Ahmed sits left, Kamran sits right. Karak glasses on the table or in hand.
- Podcast mics on boom arms beside them, never covering a mouth.
- Natural, friendly acting: looking at each other while they chat, at the camera to open and close.

✕ NEVER

- No outfit changes mid-scene. No ties, suits or sunglasses. (The AI once gave Kamran a tie when he said "tie": cut around it.)
- No extra people on set, no other characters wearing the hosts' outfits.
- No red clothing or props.
- No realistic photo versions: always the animated style.
- Never put words in the hosts' mouths about real people or companies without a source.





10 · THE STUDIO

A broadcast studio above Dubai

A real TV talk-show studio, never a living room, high above the city at dusk. It feels premium but relaxed: two friends in comfortable chairs, karak on the table, the Burj Khalifa between them and AI glowing on the walls.

1. **Lighting truss with spotlights**
2. **Curved window, Burj Khalifa at dusk**
3. **Neural-network LED walls**
4. **Broadcast camera**
5. **Charcoal leather swivel chairs**
6. **Podcast mics on boom arms**
7. **Round glowing table, karak glasses**
8. **Raised circular platform, cyan edge**

SET RULES

- Time of day is always dusk: orange-pink to deep-blue sky.
- Burj Khalifa visible between the hosts in wide shots.
- LED walls show only abstract neural-network graphics, never text.
- No logos or readable text inside the set; brand graphics are added in the edit.
- No red anywhere.

11 · STUDIO LIGHTING & FRAMING

Teal and amber, always at dusk



Two-shot: the default conversation frame.



Close-up, Ahmed: punchlines, questions.

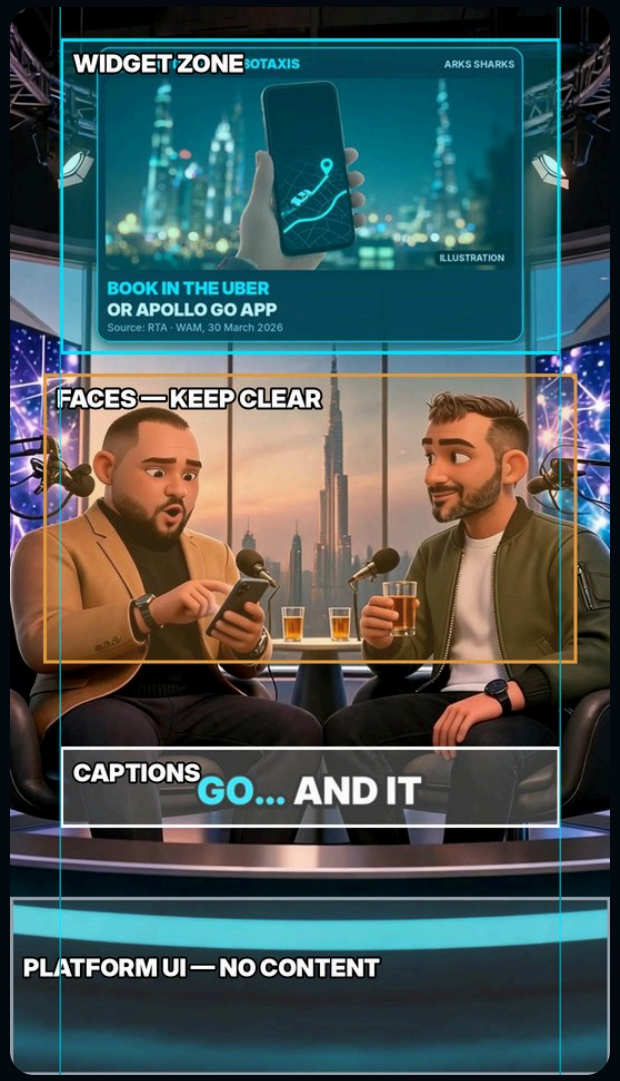


Close-up, Kamran: reactions, stories.



Exterior: brand film and trailer titles only.

KEY LIGHT	Warm amber, front-left
RIM LIGHT	Cool cyan-violet from the LED walls
ATMOSPHERE	Light haze in the spotlight beams
GRADE	Teal and amber, rich but natural skin
LENS	Shallow depth of field, subtle film grain
CAMERA	Slow push-ins and gentle arcs; hard cuts between shots
NEVER	Red tones, harsh flat light, daylight scenes



12 · 9:16 LAYOUT & SAFE ZONES

Every frame has a place for everything

WIDGET ZONE · TOP

y 58–625 px, 800 px wide, centred. Topic cards live here. Faces must never be covered: frame the hosts lower when widgets are used.

FACES · MIDDLE

y 660–1180 px. Keep clear of all graphics. Name tags go just below the faces on first appearance.

CAPTIONS · LOWER MIDDLE

Baseline at about y 1450 px, inside 90 px side margins. One to three words at a time.

PLATFORM UI · BOTTOM

The bottom 320 px is covered by TikTok, Reels and Shorts buttons. No text, logos or key action there.

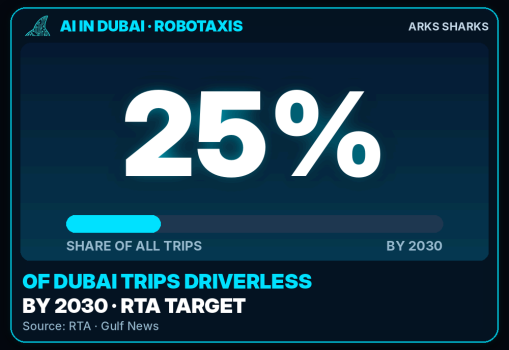
Universal safe area: **900 × 1400 px centred**. Headline tags sit at the very top (y ≈ 250 px) when no widget is showing.

13 · ON-SCREEN GRAPHICS

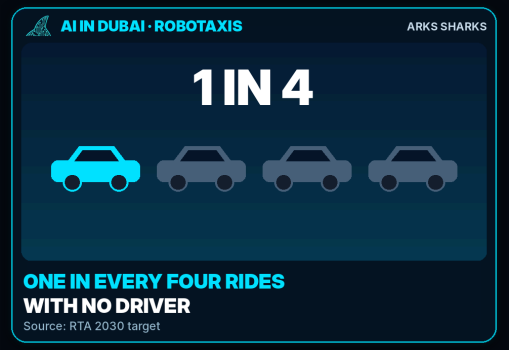
The graphics system



Topic widget, image card. Header: fin + topic in cyan + "ARKS SHARKS". Image with an ILLUSTRATION tag when AI-made. Headline in two lines. Source line, always.



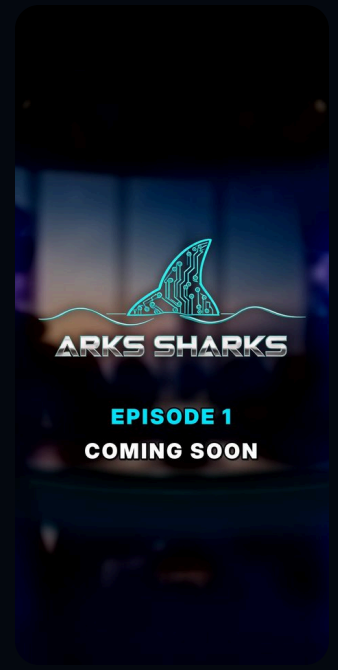
Stat card. One big number, a progress bar, a two-line headline and the source.



Ratio card. "N in M" with icons; the highlighted one in Shark Cyan.



Headline tag + captions.



End card. Blurred studio, logo, episode line.

WIDGETS

Change on every line of dialogue. Slide in 36 px and fade in over 0.3 s; fade out over 0.2 s.

SOURCES

Every factual card shows "Source: ..." with the outlet and date. Opinions and jokes don't need one.

NAME TAGS

White on Deep Navy, under each host for the first 4 seconds of a video.

LOGO SLAM

At the title moment: logo scales from 150% to 100% with a bass hit, holds about 2 s.

14 · MOTION & EDITING

Hook fast, then talk like friends



0–2.5 s: the hook. Strongest line, headline tag, small logo, captions. No opener.



Brand film (trailers and promos only): the shark dives through the studio glass.



Brand film end: lights up, logo lands, sonic logo.

EDITING RULES

- **Hook in the first 3 s**, with on-screen text from frame 1.
- Trailers: a new cut every 2–4 s. Episodes: let conversations breathe.
- **No opener.** Every video starts with a 2.5 s hook, then the sound-logo hit cuts into the conversation.
- Hard cuts between shots; no flashy transitions.
- Captions on everything: most viewers watch muted.
- Cover AI glitches (outfit morphs, odd hands) with a reaction cutaway.

APPROVED TRAILER STRUCTURE (55 S)

Hook · 7 s	Title · logo slam · 5 s	Who we are · 7.5 s	Rapid-fire news · 9 s	Funny corner · 14 s	Sign-off · 9 s	End card

15 · SOUND IDENTITY

Their real voices, clean and close

VOICES

Always the hosts' **own cloned voices** (Cartesia), UK English with their natural accents. Never a stock voice.

Lip-sync route: the animation is generated from the lines, then each speaker is converted back to his real voice so the timing matches the mouth.

VOICE PROCESSING

- De-reverb (WPE)
- Neural noise removal (RNNoise, voice model)
- Gentle spectral denoise
- De-click, de-ess
- EQ: −2.5 dB at 220 Hz, +2.2 dB at 3.8 kHz, +1.5 dB air shelf
- Light compression (2.2:1)

No noise gate: it swallows soft consonants.

LOUDNESS

MASTER	−14 LUFS integrated
TRUE PEAK	≤ −1.5 dBTP
MUSIC BED	18–20 dB under dialogue, side-chain ducked
SFX	6 dB under dialogue

SONIC LOGO

Low drone → riser → sub impact, then a bright three-note motif **A – E – A** with a shimmer tail. Plays as the hook cuts into the conversation, and on title slams.

MUSIC

Original, licence-free beds made for the show: 120 BPM cinematic electronic, chords Am – F – C – G. Trailer mode has the hook drone, riser and impacts; conversation mode is a soft groove. **Never** use tracks with unclear rights.

16 · TONE OF VOICE & CONTENT RULES

Sound like two mates who know their stuff

VOICE

- UK English, short sentences, spoken not written.
- Light Arabic flavour used naturally: **Yalla**, **Habibi**, **Wallah**, **Shukran**.
- Questions and reactions between the hosts keep it a conversation.
- Explain jargon in one breath ("agentic AI: AI that actually does tasks for you").

CONTENT RULES

- Every fact is real, recent and sourced; the source appears on screen.
- AI-made pictures carry the "ILLUSTRATION" tag.
- Funny corner: real, documented AI fails only.
- Kind humour: laugh at the tech, never at people.
- No claims about real people's experiences unless they're true.

SAY IT LIKE THIS

✓ “Mate, you already can! Umm Suqeim and Jumeirah, since March.”

✕ “Commercial autonomous mobility services have been deployed in select districts.”

✓ “Treat AI like a brilliant intern: fast, helpful, but check its work.”

✕ “AI will replace everyone by next year.” (unsourced hype)

SIGN-OFF & CATCHPHRASES

“We hunt the AI news... so you don't have to.” · “New features. Funny fails. Real talk.” · “ARKS Sharks! Yalla... dive in!”

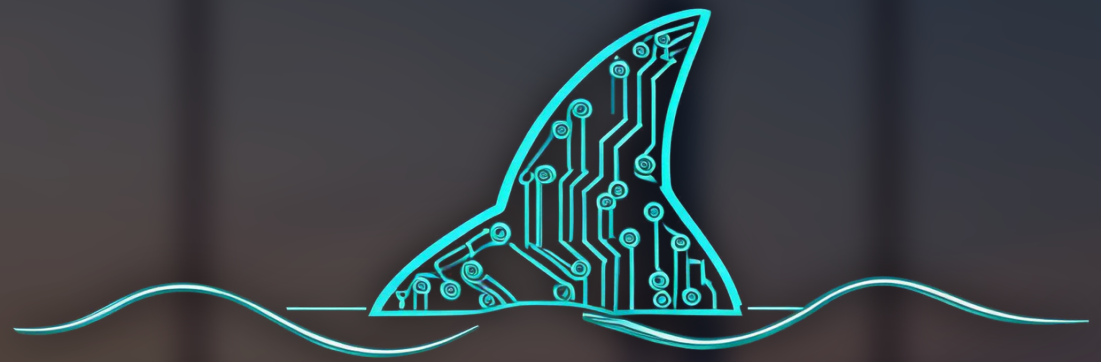
17 · TECHNICAL SPECS & ASSET INDEX

Make it the same way every time

FORMAT	9:16 vertical, 1080 × 1920, 24 fps
VIDEO	H.264, CRF 20, yuv420p, fast-start
AUDIO	AAC 192 kbps, 44.1 kHz stereo, −14 LUFS
GENERATION	Seedance 2.0 reference-to-video, 720p, upscaled to 1080p; Seedream 5.0 for stills
VOICES	Cartesia sonic-3 · Ahmed c1063679-503f… · Kamran f21c147a-0d3b…
RECIPE	`.claude/skills/arks-sharks-video/SKILL.md`
TOOLS	`show/tools/` (generation, voice swap, clean-up, widgets, assembly, finalise)

LOGO	`show/brand/arks_sharks_logo_*.png / .jpg`
CHARACTERS	`characters/ahmed/, characters/kamran/` (masters, expressions)
STUDIO	`show/trailer/keyframes/talkshow_studio.jpg, kf_two/kf_ahm/kf_kam.jpg`
APPROVED TRAILER	`show/final/ARKS_Sharks_Trailer_v1_APPROVED_9x16.mp4`
HOOK	`show/tools/hook.py` (2.5 s, no opener). Brand film for trailers: `show/final/ARKS_Sharks_Episode_Intro_v1_9x16.mp4`
WIDGET STYLE	`show/tools/widgets.py` + example cards in `show/tests/conv20/`
PROMPTS	`show/trailer/prompts/` (identity strings, set, lighting)
THIS BOOK	`show/brand/ci/build_ci.py` rebuilds it

Identity strings for generation: **Ahmed**: round full face, buzzed receding dark hair, full short black beard, camel-tan blazer over a black turtleneck, silver watch. **Kamran**: dark wavy textured hair with short faded sides, full dark beard with a salt-and-pepper grey chin, olive-green bomber jacket over a white t-shirt, black smartwatch.



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